TryHackMe Room Writeup 4 of 6

TryHackMe: Windows Basics

Network Traffic Analysis, Nmap and Windows Logging | Week 2 | Lab Part

Room detail	Details
Platform	TryHackMe
Room	Windows Basics
Room link	https://tryhackme.com/room/windowsbasics
Public profile	https://tryhackme.com/p/hariniedward
Status	Completed, 100%
About the room	Learn to navigate Windows, manage files and use essential system tools.

Objective

This room introduces Windows through a first day at work scenario. My aim was to get comfortable with the interface, file management, system settings and the built in tools for monitoring and security that I will rely on later when reading logs.

What I learned

- Windows has three common account types: Guest for restricted access, Standard for everyday work, and Administrator with full control.
- The desktop and taskbar bring together the Start menu, search, task view, pinned apps, network and audio settings, date and time, and notifications.
- File Explorer shows the folder hierarchy and the full path of any folder.
- The About your PC page in Settings shows the device name, installed memory and Windows version.
- Applications can be installed from the Microsoft Store or from a vendor installer (.exe or .msi), and removed through Settings, Control Panel or the app's own uninstaller.
- Windows Settings is the modern place for configuration and Control Panel is the older one.
- Task Manager has five tabs: Processes, Performance, Users, Details and Services.
- Windows Security covers virus and threat protection, firewall and network protection, app and browser control, and device security. Windows Defender Firewall applies different rules to Domain, Private and Public networks.

Tools I used

Tool	What it does	Why a SOC analyst cares
File Explorer	Browse, search and organise files and folders.	Finding suspicious files and reading paths correctly.
Settings and Control Panel	Configure the system, users, apps and network.	Checking installed software and configuration changes.
Task Manager	Shows processes, performance, users and services.	Spotting unfamiliar processes and unusual resource use.
Windows Security	Scans for threats and shows protection status.	Confirming protection is on and reviewing detections.
Windows Defender Firewall	Allows or blocks traffic using rules.	Reviewing inbound and outbound rules for risky exposure.

The practical task

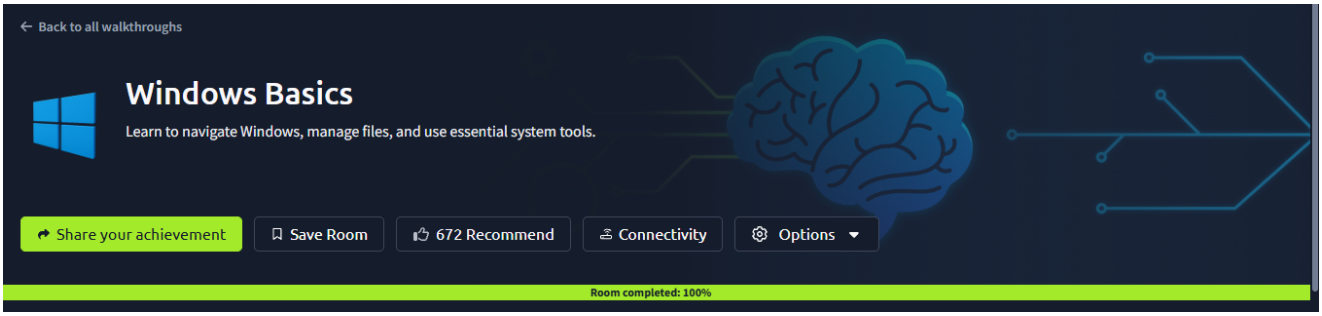
- Read the device name, installed memory and Windows version on the About your PC page.
- Opened the onboarding folder and read the file inside it.
- Installed the provided application and noted the result.
- Checked the language and region settings and the signed in account on the Users tab of Task Manager.
- Ran a custom scan of the onboarding folder with Windows Security. It detected the harmless EICAR test file, and I opened the details of that detection.
- Looked at the advanced settings of Windows Defender Firewall to see how inbound and outbound rules are listed.

Why this matters for a SOC analyst

- Most alerts come from Windows machines, so knowing what a normal system looks like makes unusual behaviour easier to notice.
- The EICAR file is a safe way to see what a detection looks like and to confirm that antivirus is working.
- Task Manager and the firewall rules are among the first places to look on a suspected host.

> **Key takeaway**
> This room gave me the baseline of how a normal Windows machine looks and behaves. That baseline is what later makes event logs and suspicious activity make sense.

Completion proof



Room page showing 100% completion. My profile details have been removed from the screenshot.

References

Room: https://tryhackme.com/room/windowsbasics

My public profile: https://tryhackme.com/p/hariniedward